



Republic of the Philippines
DEPARTMENT OF TRANSPORTATION

DEPARTMENT ORDER NO. 2021 - 007

**TO : ALL OFFICIALS AND EMPLOYEES
DOTr-CO, MRT-3, CAR AND CARAGA
SECTORAL OFFICES AND ATTACHED AGENCIES**

**SUBJECT : RULES AND REGULATIONS GOVERNING SCHOLARSHIP AND
TRAINING PROGRAMS IN THE DEPARTMENT**

DATE : 26 April 2021

1.0. PURPOSE

This Department recognizes the importance of continuous and inclusive growth of its personnel, both professionally and personally, towards organizational progress. Hence, this Order is hereby issued to standardize the process of pursuing various Learning and Development (L&D) opportunities to build collective and individual competencies towards establishing an excellent and high performing organization which provides efficient delivery of its services consistent to this Department's mandate, mission, vision and sustainable development goals (SDG).

2.0. OBJECTIVES

- 2.1. To provide equal opportunity or access to professional growth and advancement of all personnel, regardless of age, sex, gender, disability, religion, ethnicity, social status, income, class, political affiliation or other similar factors;
- 2.2. To provide opportunities to avail of and/or access to programs, training, scholarships and study, and other fellowship grants and programs that will upgrade the competencies of the personnel;
- 2.3. To ensure that the pursuit of developing competencies is geared toward performance improvement of the respective duties and responsibilities; and
- 2.4. Establish a uniform standard and procedure in the processing of scholarship applications aligned with the organizational mandate, mission, vision and sustainable development goals (SDG) / Philippine Development Plan (PDP).

3.0. GUIDING PRINCIPLES

- 3.1. The matching of learning and development programs with the work requirements, not the reward factor, shall be the most important concern in the provision of training opportunities to DOTr personnel.
- 3.2. Following this principle, the interest of DOTr as an organization shall be paramount while personal academic interests, though legitimate concerns, shall be a secondary consideration. As such, the nature, duration, and venue of training shall always be resolved in favor of the interests and needs of the Department.
- 3.3. Career development opportunities, whether local or foreign, must be equitably and judiciously distributed across office/project units in agency, and across employee ranks and grades, based on a regular assessment of actual training needs. Notwithstanding, equity among individuals and office/project units shall be considered in the context of organizational need.
- 3.4. For study programs, the award of scholarship grants to any personnel for the entire duration of the government service shall be limited to no more than three (3) availments (i.e., 2 master's degrees and 1 doctoral degree).

4.0. SCOPE

- 4.1. This Policy shall cover all forms of study and non-study learning and development interventions, whether foreign or local and whether internally or externally funded, open to all eligible employees of the Department;
- 4.2. This Order shall apply to all DOTr-CO personnel and shall also be observed in the regional and sectoral offices and attached agencies of this Department by the HR and administrative officers and the officials involved in the assessment, selection, processing, shortlisting, and management of all learning and development interventions/programs in their respective organizations.
- 4.3. Study Leaves for the continuation, completion or fulfillment of an academic requirement (i.e., review, examination, and thesis writing/defense) are not covered by this policy. The Department through its respective administrative or HR units shall apply separate guidelines on study leave, pursuant to CSC MC No. 21 s. 2004.

5.0. GENDER EQUALITY AND SOCIAL INCLUSION (GEDSI)

The Department of Transportation aims to uphold gender equality, disability and social inclusion (GEDSI) in all its internal policies. As such, the following principles are incorporated to ensure gender-fair language, morale, efficiency, integrity, gender responsiveness, inclusiveness, progressiveness and courtesy in the workplace:

- 5.1. The Magna Carta of Women (RA 9710) mandates to eliminate discrimination against **women** by recognizing, protecting, fulfilling and promoting the rights of Filipino **women**, especially those in marginalized sector; and
- 5.2. The Magna Carta for Disabled Persons (RA 7277) and Batas Pambansa (BP) 344, which specifically, provides the rehabilitation of facilities, self-development and self-reliance of Disabled Persons and their integration into the mainstream of society;
- 5.3. The 2017 Omnibus Rules on Appointments and Other Human Resource Actions (ORA-OHRA), Revised in 2018 prohibits the discriminatory practices against or in any person examined or to be examined by the agency by reason of the individual's political or religious opinions or affiliations, sex, sexual orientation and gender identity, civil status, age, disability, or ethnicity.¹

6.0. DEFINITION OF TERMS

- 6.1. **Applicant** shall refer to the Department or agency's employee who submitted an application to a scholarship or training program through the Personnel Development Committee (PDC) Secretariat concerned and is duly endorsed by the head of the office concerned.
- 6.2. **Candidate** shall refer to the applicant duly evaluated by the PDC Secretariat as having met the minimum eligibility requirements of the Department and/or the Development Partner and is qualified to undergo the selection process of the PDC concerned for nomination to the scholarship or training program.
- 6.3. **Grantee** refers to the eligible DOTr/agency employee duly nominated by the Department or agency concerned and accepted or confirmed by the Development Partner as participant to the concerned scholarship or training program.
- 6.4. **Individual Development Plan (IDP)** pertains to the summary of personnel's developmental needs identifying the list of competencies which the personnel must possess to make them effective in the existing and future role in the organization.
- 6.5. **Learning and Development (L&D) Intervention or Program** refers to the learning opportunities offered locally or abroad in the form of training, workshops, seminars, online short courses, fellowships, and scholarship programs.
- 6.6. **Mentoring Program** refers to a partnership between a more experienced and more knowledgeable member of the organization and the personnel selected

¹ Sec. 134 of CSC Resolution No. 180069 dated 03 July 2018 re. the 2017 Omnibus Rules on Appointments and Other Human Resource Actions (ORA-OHRA), Revised in 2018.

as the recipient of the LDI for the purpose of providing guidance and support in the development and implementation of the Re-entry Action Plan (REAP) of the latter.

- 6.7. **Nominee** refers to the eligible DOTr/agency employee duly nominated by the Department or agency concerned to a scholarship or training program but has yet to be accepted or confirmed by the Development Partner concerned;
- 6.8. **Non-Study Program** refers to specialized interventions and other short-term courses that do not lead to an academic degree e.g., training, seminars, conferences, conventions, fellowships, special missions, with specific themes offered abroad.
- 6.9. **On Official Time** refers to attendance in study or non-study training programs undertaken during official hours with entitlements to salaries and other benefits due them as government officials or employees.
- 6.10. **Pool of Potential Scholars** refers to the talent database which contains a list of personnel, who are potential nominees for scholarship programs taking into consideration relevance of work function and role in the organization.
- 6.11. **Re-Entry Action Plan (REAP)** is a program/project undertaken by the scholar/grantee focusing on the development of the organization's area of priority to make sure that the availed learning & development intervention has a positive impact and guaranteed return on investment (ROI) to the organization, leading to significant improvements or innovations in the agency's delivery of services to the public.
- 6.12. **Resource Person/Learning Service Provider** refers to an expert on a particular field, who shares and delivers expertise and knowledge through conduct of a program.²
- 6.13. **Service Obligation** refers to the service for a specified period or duration that a scholar/grantee should render in the Department or any other government office or instrumentality as the exigencies of the service may require, upon return from the study or within the specified time.³
- 6.14. **Development Partner** refers to the sponsoring institution or host/donor country who offers learning opportunities to the Department or agency's personnel.
- 6.15. **Scholarship Service Contract** shall refer to the agreement entered into between the Philippine Government through the DOTr or the agency concerned, and the scholar as a requirement for (i) foreign scholarship or training with a duration of seven (7) calendar days or more; (ii) for local scholarships regardless of duration; or (iii) for local training exceeding one

² This may be sourced from within or outside the Department.

³ Section 2, Executive Order No. 367 s. 1989, "Further Amending Executive Order No. 367, s. 1989.

month, which covers the terms and conditions of the scholarship or training program.

- 6.16. **Senior Official or Senior Management Level** refers to DOTr or agency officials from Director level to Undersecretary (including those officially designated as Officer-in-Charge)
- 6.17. **Study Leave** is a time-off from work not exceeding six (6) months with pay for qualified officials and employees to help them prepare for their bar or board examinations or complete their master's degree. For completion of master's degree, the study leave shall not exceed four (4) months.

The leave shall be covered by a service obligation contract between the agency head or his/her authorized representative and the employee concerned. No extension shall be allowed if the officials or employees avail of the maximum period of leave allowed herein. If they need more time to complete their studies, they may file a leave of absence chargeable against their vacation leave credits.⁴

- 6.18. **Study Program** refers to a degree course leading to a completion of a graduate or postgraduate degree in an accredited or recognized institution.⁵
- 6.19. **Stray Scholarship**⁶ refers to programs availed through the personnel's own initiative or through direct invitation by an academic or training institution.

7.0. COMPOSITION, FUNCTIONS AND RESPONSIBILITIES AND OTHER PARTIES INVOLVED IN THE SELECTION PROCESS

7.1. COMPOSITION OF THE PERSONNEL DEVELOPMENT COMMITTEE (PDC)

	DOTr Central Office (& MRT3-PMO)	DOTr Regional Offices (CAR & CARAGA), Sectoral Offices and Attached Agencies
Chairperson	Undersecretary for Administrative Service or the designated official by the Secretary	Head of Agency or the designated official by the Secretary

⁴ CSC Memorandum Circular No. 21, s. 2004 dated 14 September 2004 – "Amendment to Section 68 of CSC MC No. 14, s. 1999 relative to the Guidelines on Study Leave."

⁵ Medium of attendance on a study program can either be face to face or remote learning.

- Face to face is when scholars physically attend the program.
- Remote learning is when the program is conducted through distance or through online platforms.

⁶ Offices developing or packaging a training program explicitly for the specific needs of their office or a part of a project administered or lodged in them shall be reported to HRDD for facilitation.

Members	Office of the Secretary	Primary division/unit on administrative matters
	Administrative Service	Primary division/unit on financial matters
	Planning Service	Primary division/unit on planning
	Organization Employees' Association	Organization Employees' Association
Secretariat	Human Resource and Development Division	Primary division/unit on learning & development matters

- a. Each identified member office/unit of the PDC shall designate its principal and alternate representatives;
- b. For the Central Office, representatives to the PDC shall have a rank not lower than a Director-level position;
- c. For regional and sectoral offices and attached agencies, the highest-ranking officer per identified office shall be the designated permanent representative to the PDC;
- d. For the Employees' Association, its principal and alternate representative shall be designated by its officers.

7.2. RESPONSIBILITIES OF THE PERSONNEL DEVELOPMENT COMMITTEE (PDC):

- a. The Personnel Development Committee of the agency concerned acts as the governing body in the formulation and implementation of the Learning and Development Plan of the Department and ensure faithful compliance to applicable policies involving the training and competency development of its existing workforce;
- b. The DOTr-CO PDC reviews and approves the availment of scholarships, study and training opportunities open to the Department's rank and file personnel. In case of nominations of officials from Director to Undersecretary, including Division Chiefs designated as Officer-in-Charge, the PDC shall only recommend to the Secretary for final approval;

- c. The Sectoral PDC reviews and approves the availment of scholarships, study and training opportunities open to the agency's rank and file personnel. In case of nominations of officials from Director to Undersecretary, including Division Chiefs designated as Officer-in-Charge, the Sectoral PDC of the concerned agency shall only recommend to the Secretary through the DOTr-CO PDC for final approval.
- d. The PDC concerned reviews and approves the selection of DOTr nominees to both local and foreign scholarships and study/training programs, except for local programs with a duration of one (1) month or less;⁷
- e. However, for invitations to training and scholarship programs extended by the DOTr-CO PDC to the regional and sectoral offices and attached agencies, the concerned agency's PDC shall only recommend their selected candidate for nomination, subject to the final approval by the DOTr-CO PDC.
- f. Likewise, for invitations directly extended by the Development Partner to the regional and sectoral offices and attached agencies which require the endorsement of the mother agency in the submission of nominees, the concerned agency's PDC shall only recommend their selected candidate for nomination, subject to the final approval by the DOTr-CO PDC.
- g. The PDC concerned reviews and approves the participation of a DOTr grantee to study and non-study learning and development programs (including stray scholarships) on official time, subject to the provisions of Section 11.0 of this Order.
- h. The PDC concerned reviews and approves any request for extension of the grantee's participation to the study or non-study L&D program, subject to the provisions of Section 11.0 of this Order.
- i. Formulates and imposes sanctions to discourage withdrawal after a nominee's acceptance to the scholarship or training program or at any point during the study proper of the scholarship and training program unless the cited reason for withdrawal cited is beyond the candidate's control.⁸
- j. When applicable, reviews and approves the finalized version of the proposed Re-Entry Action Plan (REAP) of the grantee prior to its implementation, and evaluates and approves the same upon completion.

⁷ In such cases, selection and approval of nominees to the local non-study program shall be devolved to the concerned office, provided that the nominated employee meets the minimum eligibility requirements of the Department and/or the Development Partner as evaluated by the PDC Secretariat concerned.

⁸ Examples of valid reasons for withdrawal which are beyond the candidate's control include but are not limited to the following: (a) high risk pregnancy, (b) emergency cases that pose potential threat to the life of the selected candidate and/or one's immediate family member, (c) death of an immediate family member, and (d) physical or mental impairment as a result of uncontrollable events. In such or similar cases, the DOTr-CO PDC shall refrain from imposing sanctions for the candidate's withdrawal.

- k. Approves actions in the enforcement of the scholarship service contract against grantees who have failed to serve their respective service obligations in full or for any violation of its terms and conditions; and,
- l. Authorizes the engagement of services of other training institutions or agencies, whether private or government, and individual subject matter experts in the conduct of in-house training and career development programs, and including the appropriate fees, rates of honoraria for resource persons, and other training related expenses as determined by the PDC Secretariat concerned.⁹

7.3. RESPONSIBILITIES OF THE PDC SECRETARIAT

The PDC Secretariat shall provide technical and administrative support in the implementation of the entire scholarship process/training, which shall include but are not limited to the following:

- a. Preparation of the invitation, agenda, minutes and other materials of the meetings held by the PDC concerned;
- b. Maintains a comprehensive database of regularly scheduled and/or availed study and non-study L&D programs by the Department or agency concerned every year, including analytical metrics to measure their consistency, effectiveness and value-for-money vis a vis the performance of the individual employee and the agency;
- c. Pre-selection of potential candidates to identified L&D programs through the conduct of an Organizational Training Needs Assessment (OTNA), preparation of an Individual Development Plan of every employee, and consolidation of the agency's Learning and Development Plan on an annual basis;
- d. Conducting preliminary evaluation of scholarship or training programs offered to the Department and prepares the appropriate recommendation to the PDC and the concerned offices and agencies;
- e. Reviews course or program objectives to ensure alignment with the overall organizational mandate of the agency;
- f. Acting as the focal point in the coordination with Development Partners sponsoring the study and non-study L&D programs and with the host institutions and/or countries where the DOTr grantees are completing the same;
- g. Disseminates invitations to the target beneficiaries and appropriate recipient offices on behalf of the and the Development Partner, including the pre-

⁹ This excludes training programs which are inherent components of projects implemented by specific offices.

identified potential candidates to the L&D program in accordance with Section 11.1 of this Order;

- h. Conducts preliminary evaluation and screening of applicants to determine whether they meet the minimum eligibility requirements set by the Development Partner and the PDC pursuant to the provisions of this Order, and other applicable government policies;
- i. Ensures that the selection of nominees takes into account the mutual needs of the agency and the individual employee/s applying for the scholarship or training program, provided that the overall competency development of the organization shall be given primary consideration over the personal training needs of the personnel concerned per the candidate's Individual Development Plan (IDP);
- j. Monitors the nomination and availment by of DOTr personnel of scholarship and training opportunities to prevent the redundant, simultaneous or successive participation of an employee to the same or similar study or non-study programs;
- k. Drafts resolutions and/or referenda regarding the selection of nominee/s to study and non-study programs to be signed and approved by the members of the PDC;
- l. Submits the formal nomination of the candidate/s selected by the PDC, including the required documentary requirements, to the Development Partner sponsoring or hosting the L&D program within the stipulated deadline;
- m. Upon confirmed acceptance to the scholarship or training program, provides proper guidance and extends necessary assistance to the grantee in accomplishing the pre-admission and/or pre-departure requirements identified by the Development Partner and those of the Department, including the signing and execution of the Scholarship Service Contract (SSC) and securing of the required clearances and authorizations for the expected travel (when applicable);
- n. Monitors the progress and performance of the grantee during the study proper and provides adequate support system to safeguard the welfare of the DOTr employee throughout the L&D program;¹⁰
- o. Provides proper guidance and extends necessary assistance to the grantee upon completion of the scholarship or training program and in preparation for the grantee' departure from the host institution or country;¹¹

¹⁰ For training and scholarship programs extended by the DOTr-CO PDC to the regional and sectoral offices and attached agencies, the Sectoral PDC Secretariat shall be primarily responsible in monitoring the grantee's progress during the program, the fulfillment of the required service obligation after completing the program, and the implementation of the grantee's Re-Entry Action Plan (REAP), if applicable.

¹¹ Refer to the preceding citation.

- p. Monitors whether the grantees have returned, reported back to work, and have started serving the required service obligation per the executed Scholarship Service Contract;¹²
- q. Oversees the timely submission of post-program requirements, including the preparation of written post-training reports, skills and knowledge sharing based on the learnings from the program attended, and the finalization and implementation of the Re-Entry Action Plan (when applicable);¹³
- r. Certifies that the grantee has rendered the service obligation to the Department in full or, in the event of failure to serve fully or partially the same, ensures the grantee has been cleared from accountabilities only upon settlement of pending deliverables and compliance to imposed sanctions or penalties as stipulated in the executed Scholarship Service Contract;¹⁴
- s. Upon approval by the PDC, refers scholarship-related cases (e.g., violation of any provisions of the Scholarship Service Contract) to the Legal Service;
- t. Serves as the research and technical support arm of the PDC;
- u. Provide timely feedback to DOTr offices on actions taken on individual nominations;
- v. Conducts quarterly reporting on scholarship invitations, availments, status of grantees, and all necessary details relevant thereto for information of the Department; and
- w. Monitor and initiate appropriate actions on concerns relative to membership of the PDC.

7.4. FUNCTIONS AND RESPONSIBILITIES OF OTHER PARTIES

7.4.1. Department Secretary

- a. Acts on the recommendation of the DOTr-CO PDC in cases where officials occupying Director to Undersecretary positions shall participate in any study or non-study program; and,
- b. Renders final decision on grievances of concerned personnel or office for any errors, lapses and irregularities committed by the PDC and the Secretariat in implementing the standard policies, practices and procedures during the selection process as stipulated in this Order.

¹² Refer to the preceding citation.

¹³ Refer to the preceding citation.

¹⁴ Refer to the preceding citation.

7.4.2. PDC Chairperson¹⁵

- a. Authorizes dissemination of invitations and requests for nominations to L&D programs to the appropriate offices; and,
- b. Recommends to the Department Secretary for approval the participation in L&D programs which requires the attendance of senior officials of the Department.

7.4.3. Employees' Association Representative

- a. Ensures that the welfare of employees is appropriately considered in the application and implementation of policies and guidelines governing the learning and development of all DOTr personnel; and,
- b. Promotes fairness and equality in the availing of scholarship/training/study programs, and in the selection and approval of nominees to the same.

7.4.4. Head of the Office Concerned

- a. Selects and recommends the application of interested employees within the office;
- b. Endorses the request for study on official time (including stray scholarships) or extension of the same and other related requests;
- c. Monitors the grantee's delivery of required outputs during and after the scholarship or training program upon return to duty;
- d. Ensures the grantee's faithful compliance to the terms of conditions of the executed Scholarship Service Contract, including rendering the required service obligation upon completion of the L&D program (if applicable); and,
- e. Observes compliance with the office retention limit requirement such that not more than 20% of the actual filled up positions of an office can be authorized for study on official time or study leave at any given time.

7.4.5. Grantee

- a. Complies with all the guidelines and requirements specified by the Department and the Development Partner upon acceptance, during and after completion of the scholarship or training program;
- b. Regularly provides updates and progress reports to the PDC Secretariat during the Study Proper;

¹⁵ Pursuant to Item 7.1 of this Order, the Chairperson of the DOTr-CO PDC shall be the Undersecretary of the Administrative Service or the designated official by the Department Secretary; the Chairperson of the Sectoral PDC shall be the Head of Agency or the designated official by the Department Secretary.

- c. Delivers the required outputs during and after completion of the scholarship or training program as committed to the Department and the Development Partner, including but not limited to the following:
 - i. Submission of written report (for short-term training or study) or post-training report (for long-term training or study) within seven (7) days or thirty (30) days respectively, upon return to duty;
 - ii. Application, sharing or delivery of skills learned from the study or training (including the conduct of echo session/s for the transfer of knowledge) within third (30) days upon return to duty; and,
 - iii. Submission of the Re-Entry Action Plan (REAP) prior to the start of the program and its finalization and implementation upon return of the grantee (when applicable);
- d. Faithfully complies to the terms and conditions of the executed Scholarship Service Contract, including rendering the required service obligation upon return to work; and,
- e. When applicable, submits a Re-Entry Action Plan (REAP) prior to the start of the program and finalizes and implements the same upon the grantee's resumption of duty.

7.5. GENERAL RULES ON PROCEEDINGS OF THE PDC

- a. The PDC shall convene and hold regular meetings at least on a quarterly basis. A special meeting may also be called by the PDC Chairperson or the PDC Secretariat in the event of urgent matters requiring immediate action. For either case, prior notice shall be issued through the PDC Secretariat.
- b. A quorum must be acquired to hold regular and special meetings. In case the PDC is not able to acquire a quorum in a meeting, the committee can pass a resolution via referendum which shall be coursed the non-attending regular members who shall affix their conformity thereto.
- c. In case of unforeseen circumstances where the PDC Chairperson is not available to attend the scheduled meeting, the Chairperson may designate in writing a proxy within the existing principal members of the committee to preside over the meeting. In such cases, the office identified as the proxy Chairperson shall in turn be represented by its alternate representative.
- d. Alternatively, the Chairperson may approve the adoption of the Committee's resolution through referendum instead of designating a proxy to the meeting.
- e. In the absence of a principal representative, only the officially designated alternate shall be authorized participate in the meeting and assume the voting rights of the former.

- f. In case the principal and the alternative representatives of an office are both present, only the vote of the principal representative shall be considered.
- g. PDC decisions or resolutions adopted via referendum shall require the conformity of at least the majority of the regular members of the Committee, including the PDC Chairperson.

8.0. RULES OF PROCEDURE ON THE SELECTION OF NOMINEES AND MANAGEMENT OF GRANTEES OR TRAINEES

8.1. PRE-SELECTION STAGE

A. GENERAL GUIDELINES

8.1.1. The PDC Secretariat (or the HR division/unit) of the agency concerned shall develop and update annually the agency's **HR Learning and Development Plan**, which shall serve as a guide in the selection of nominees to various scholarship and training programs. This L&D plan shall detail, among others, the following:

- a. A catalogue of categorized study and non-study programs regularly availed by the agency, including the scheduled and anticipated offerings of the Development Partners;
- b. A list of offices identified as target beneficiaries by the Department and the Development Partner for each training or scholarship program;
- c. A list of potential nominees or candidates per training or scholarship program; and,
- d. A compilation of the **Individual Development Plans (IDPs)** of all employees of the agency.

8.1.2. The HR Learning and Development Plan shall be based on the annual **Organizational Training Needs Assessment (OTNA)** approved by the PDC within the first (1st) quarter of each calendar year.

B. LEARNING AND DEVELOPMENT FRAMEWORK

8.1.3. The development of the HR Learning and Development Plan of the agency shall observe the following framework in categorizing its existing positions and in determining the suitable learning and development interventions for each career group, to wit:

Career Group A	Unique Technical Positions	Planning, Policy Formulation and Analysis, Engineering, Public Administration, Law, Systems Analysis, and other similar fields
Career Group B	Service Wide Technical Positions	Personnel, Finance, Accounting, Communications and other auxiliary services
Career Group C	Non-Technical Positions	1 st level positions within services, offices, units

C. TYPES OF PROGRAMS AND TARGET BENEFICIARIES

- 8.1.4. The HR unit or PDC Secretariat of the agency concerned shall categorize the identified study and non-study programs in the HR Learning and Development Plan based on the following:

Skill Gap-Filling	Designed to fill the gap between the required competencies of a job and the actual competency of the personnel whose performance requires improvement, or when the personnel aspires for a higher position or shift in career path consistent with the strategic objectives of the Department.
Competency Enhancement	Refers to a) basic transport development and infrastructure related programs, basic courses on management and leadership, introductory courses, orientation and values development programs, information technology familiarization programs, and lecture series on technical subject areas; b) group targeted courses i.e., conference management, technical support writing, supervisory development programs, team development workshops.
Professional Development	Pertain to programs in preparation for personnel to assume higher positions consistent to the career path aligned with strategic objectives of the Department. For incumbents of supervisory positions or their equivalent in Career Groups A, B, and C above.

	These include local non-degree, post-graduate enrichment programs to complement masters or doctoral degrees, and short-term exchange programs, study tours and research programs.
Executive Development	Refer to programs for which local and foreign Development Partners expressly require the attendance of senior officials.

- 8.1.5. Likewise, the Individual Development Plan (IDP) of each employee shall be aligned with the abovementioned categories.

8.2. SELECTION STAGE

A. INVITATION TO THE PROGRAM

- 8.2.1. Upon receipt of the invitation from the Development Partner, the PDC Secretariat shall evaluate the learning and development program to determine, among others, the following:
- a. Minimum eligibility requirements identified the Development Partner for the applicants,
 - b. Checklist of documentary requirements for applicants,
 - c. Post-study outputs and deliverables (e.g., REAP) upon completion of the program, and
 - d. Assignment of resident mentor (*if necessary*).
- 8.2.2. The PDC Secretariat shall extend invitations to the target beneficiaries or appropriate recipient offices and the potential eligible candidates for nomination therein as identified in the HR Learning and Development Plan. Invitations may be extended to other offices, provided that preference shall be accorded to the identified target beneficiaries per the L&D Plan.
- 8.2.3. Applications to any scholarship or training program shall be submitted to the PDC Secretariat for initial evaluation and processing. Only those who have met the minimum eligibility requirements set by the agency concerned and the Development Partners shall be subject to deliberation before the PDC.

B. MINIMUM ELIGIBILITY REQUIREMENTS

- 8.2.4. As a general rule, only permanent government employees are eligible to undergo learning and development programs organized by the agency and/or sponsored by the Development Partners.

- 8.2.5. Non-career government personnel such as co-terminus, temporary, casual and contractual personnel may be eligible to apply for local non-study L&D programs, provided that the employee has rendered at least six (6) months of service within the agency concerned.
- 8.2.6. Any employee interested in applying to any available learning and development program of the agency must not have a pending administrative case.
- 8.2.7. In conjunction with the preceding items, the applicant must meet the minimum eligibility requirements of the Development Partner relative to education, experience, age, language proficiency, and others in order to be considered for selection and nomination.¹⁶
- 8.2.8. An applicant who has enjoyed a scholarship grant to a study program (whether foreign or local) in the immediate past two (2) years shall automatically be disqualified from consideration.¹⁷
- 8.2.9. In no case shall pregnancy, motherhood, disabilities, or lack of consent of the husband be grounds for disqualification of the applicant.¹⁸
- 8.2.10. As the prequalification standards vary relative to the respective courses or programs offered by the Development Partners, the baseline eligibility requirements of the Department for applicants to **local or foreign study programs** are set as follows:
- a. The applicant must have a permanent appointment;
 - b. The functions and duties performed by the applicant and the competencies of the occupied position must be relevant to the course applied for;
 - c. The applicant must have obtained at least a Very Satisfactory (VS) performance rating or its equivalent for the two consecutive periods immediately preceding the nomination;
 - d. The applicant must have no pending administrative¹⁹ and/or criminal case;
 - e. The applicant must have served at least two (2) years of continuous government service, with at least one (1) year having been served in the agency concerned at the time of the application. However, this requirement is without prejudice to the waiver of the Development Partner under exceptional cases;

¹⁶ CSC Memorandum Circular No. 44, s. 1992 with the subject, "Guidelines and Operating Procedures in the Administration of the Scholarship Program for Government"

¹⁷ *Ibid.*

¹⁸ Item A(6), Section 16 of the Implementing Rules and Regulations of Republic Act No. 9710.

¹⁹ The pending administrative case must involve a penalty of suspension or dismissal.

- f. In the absence of specific limitations set by the Development Partner, a pregnant employee may apply to the program provided that a certification be secured from a government physician that there will be no medical impediment due to her condition.
- g. No pending REAP implementation from a previously availed scholarship or training program; and,
- h. Other requirements as may be prescribed by the Development Partner (e.g., The applicant must occupy the minimum position level or salary grade, if relevant to the program offered);

C. SUBMISSION OF MINIMUM DOCUMENTARY REQUIREMENTS

8.2.11. Aside from the documentary requirements identified by the Development Partner, applications from interested personnel shall only be considered for evaluation upon complete submission of the following:

- a. Accomplished Nomination Form²⁰ signed by the head of office concerned;
- b. Updated Personal Data Sheet (PDS);
- c. Updated Service Record;
- d. Statement of actual duties and responsibilities;
- e. Individual Performance Commitment Review (IPCR) ratings for the last two (2) rating periods;
- f. Accomplished Potential Assessment Form²¹;
- g. List of training and scholarship programs attended in the last two (2) years;
- h. Certification of No Pending Administrative Case;
- i. Proposed Re-Entry Action Plan (REAP).²²

D. EVALUATION OF CANDIDATES

8.2.12. If the applicant meets the minimum eligibility requirements of the scholarship or training program, the PDC Secretariat shall prepare an evaluation report for the deliberation of the PDC which shall contain, among others, the following:

- a. The specific course or training title applied in the study or non-study L&D program, which must address a critical competency gap of the individual and the organization;

²⁰ See **Annex C** for the standard template of the Nomination Form.

²¹ See **Annex D** for the standard template for the Potential Assessment Form

²² A REAP proposal is a standard document requirement for all study programs and for non-study programs where the implementation of a REAP is a post-completion deliverable of the grantee as identified by the Development Partner. See **Annex E** for the standard template of this form.

- b. If applicable to L&D program concerned, the proposed re-entry action plan, which must have a valuable contribution to the strategic objectives of the agency; and,
- c. The individual competency and behavioral profile of the applicant using various assessment tools available (e.g., proficiency/competency assessment tests, behavioral event interviews, etc.)

8.2.13. The selection of nominees for all study and non-study programs (whether local or foreign grants) shall be subject to the deliberation and approval of the PDC of the agency concerned. However, in cases where the invitation was extended by the DOTr-Central Office to its sectoral offices and attached agencies, the Sectoral PDC concerned shall endorse its selected nominees to the DOTr-CO PDC for approval.

8.2.14. As an exception to Item 8.2.13, the selection of nominees for all local non-study programs with a duration of less than thirty (30) days shall be devolved to the identified target beneficiary or recipient office, provided that the minimum eligibility requirements set by the agency concerned and the Development Partners are met as evaluated by the PDC Secretariat.

8.2.15. For executive development programs where only senior officials of the agency concerned are eligible due to the requirements of the Development Partner, recommended nominees of the PDC shall be subject for the final approval of the Secretary.

E. SELECTION CRITERIA

8.2.16. The following selection criteria shall be observed by the PDC in assessing the suitability of the candidates to the scholarship or training program concerned:

- a. **RANK AND FILE PERSONNEL**
(Division Chief or Equivalent and Below)

i. QUANTITATIVE (80%)

CRITERIA	STUDY	NON-STUDY
Position	0	10
Length of Service	20	10
Necessity	50	50
Equity	30	30
TOTAL	100	100

**Please refer to Annex A for the Rating Guide*

ii. QUALITATIVE (20%)

Creativity and innovativeness	25
Capacity to transfer skills learned in a program to other DOTr personnel	25
Ability to articulate DOTr's or the Philippine Government's interest	25
Demonstration or potential managerial/leadership skills	25
TOTAL	100

b. SENIOR OFFICIALS

- i. As the requirements for executive development or enrichment programs may likewise vary relative to the standards of the Development Partners, officials shall undergo preliminary scoring on the basis of the following:

Equity ²³	40
Relevance	30
Demonstration of overall managerial competence	20
Ability to articulate DOTr or the Philippine Government's interest	10
TOTAL	100

- ii. The two highest ranking officials shall be recommended to the Secretary as principal and alternate nominees, respectively.

F. ADDITIONAL GUIDELINES

8.2.17. The PDC shall observe adherence to the age limit set by the Development Partner.

8.2.18. No official or employee may be sent to foreign training, conference, or attend international commitments when they are due to retire within one (1) year period as specified under the General Appropriations Act, as the case may be.²⁴

²³ This criterion shall consider all foreign travels regardless of whether degree or non-degree, except travels where the nominee acted as official representative of DOTr as presenter, rapporteur, secretariat, etc.

²⁴ Item e of Section 17 under the General Appropriations Act, FY 2021 provides:
"Section 17. Use of Government Funds. Government funds shall be utilized in accordance with the appropriations authorized for the purpose and comply with applicable laws, rules and regulations, such as, but not limited to the following:

xxx

e. Payment of foreign travel expenses of any government official and employee for training, seminar or conference abroad when the foreign mission cannot effectively represent our country or travels

8.2.19. In the exercise of promoting equal opportunity, the PDC shall as a general rule give preference to eligible nominees who have yet to be granted by the government and/or any its Development Partners a scholarship to study programs (whether local or foreign), except in the following instances:

- a. The required service obligation for a scholarship previously availed by the candidate has been fully rendered to the agency;
- b. The current program applied for is in the same field as the previously-availed program and is designed as an advancement²⁵ to the career path or specialization of the candidate, provided that two (2) years of continuous government service has been rendered in the same field. In case the prescribed period has only been substantially served, the PDC may opt to disqualify the candidate or add the deficiency in the service obligation for the program applied for; and,
- c. In case the previous program availed is different from the field of the current program applied for, there must be at least a three (3) year interval between the date of return of the nominee and the start of the new program.

8.2.20. The resolutions or decisions of the PDC concerned as to the selection of nominees to the scholarship or training programs shall be deemed as final and are no longer subject for appeal considering the time-bound nature of the application and nomination process as established by the Development Partner;

8.2.21. For study programs (local and foreign), foreign non-study programs, or when applicable²⁶, the issued PDC resolution or referendum shall state the identified mentor of the selected nominee who shall guide the employee in the further development and implementation of the REAP in the event of acceptance and admission to the program.

8.2.22. In relation to Item 8.2.20, an applicant/candidate may file a complaint before the Grievance Committee of the agency concerned for any errors, lapses and irregularities committed by the PDC and the Secretariat in implementing the standard policies, practices and procedures during the selection process as stipulated in this Order.²⁷

necessitated by authorized international commitments, in accordance with E.O. No. 77, s. 2019, and such other issuances as may be issued thereon: **PROVIDED, That no official or employee may be sent to foreign training when they are due to retire within one (1) year after the said foreign travel;** xxx (emphasis and underscoring supplied)"

²⁵ This shall refer to the professional development (degree) programs as provided in Item 8.1(C) of this Order. To illustrate, for a master's degree previously earned, advancement shall refer to a subsequent doctorate degree. In no case shall "enrichment program" be construed as advancement or specialization of a prior enrichment program, regardless of the course content of both programs.

²⁶ i.e., When specifically required by the Development Partner or host organization.

²⁷ Section 6(b), CSC Memorandum Circular No. 02, s. 2001 with the subject, "Revised Policies on the Settlement of Grievances in the Public Sector."

8.2.23. Upon issuance of the resolution or referendum by the PDC selecting the official nominee/s of the agency to the scholarship or training program, the PDC Secretariat shall facilitate the submission of the letter of nomination and assist the selected nominee/s in complying with the documentary requirements identified by the Development Partner concerned to support the nomination.

8.3. ACCEPTANCE STAGE

8.3.1. Upon receipt of the Notice of the Acceptance from the Development Partner, the PDC Secretariat shall duly notify the nominee concerned and the nominating office or agency of the same. Conversely, the Secretariat concerned shall also inform the aforementioned parties in the event that the nominee concerned was not selected by the Development Partner for the program.

8.3.2. Following the confirmed acceptance of the nominee to the L&D program, the PDC Secretariat of the agency concerned shall guide and assist the employee on the following:

- a. Pre-admission and/or pre-departure requirements of the Development Partner and/or the host country/organization;
- b. Signing and execution of the Scholarship Service Contract in accordance with Section 11.0 of this Order (*when applicable*); and,
- c. Submission of documentary requirements for issuance of travel authority (*when applicable*), including but not limited to the following:
 - i. Request for Travel Authority,
 - ii. Endorsement from the Head of Office Concerned,
 - iii. Acceptance Letter from the Development Partner and/or host organization,
 - iv. PDC Resolution or Referendum indicating the selection of the grantee as nominee to the program,
 - v. Scholarship Service Contract²⁸ (notarized),
 - vi. Certificate of Availability of Funds (if admission to the program is with government expense),
 - vii. Breakdown of Estimated Expenses (if admission to the program is without government expense),
 - viii. Certification that the grantee has No Pending Task or Designation of Officer-in-Charge,
 - ix. Certification that the grantee has no unliquidated cash advance,
 - x. Certification that the grantee is not due for retirement, and

²⁸ See **Annex F** for the standard template of the Scholarship Service Contract pursuant to Executive Order No. 161, s. 1994

xi. Certificate of Undertaking.²⁹

8.3.3. In relation to the preceding item, the grantee shall undergo physical and medical examination if required by the Development Partner and/or the host organization, regardless of the duration of the training or scholarship program. The cost to be incurred for the medical examination after acceptance or grant of award shall be reimbursed by the Department, subject to the usual accounting and auditing rules and regulations. However, if the grantee needs further medication and/or examination thereafter, such expense shall be shouldered personally by the grantee.

8.3.4. In congruence with Section 3 of Executive Order No. 77 issued on 15 March 2019 and the Department Order establishing the Rules, Regulations and Rates of Expenses and Allowances for Official and Foreign Travels of Government Personnel,³⁰ official local or foreign travels and assignments of officials and employees of this Department must meet the following criteria:

- a. It is essential to the effective performance of an official or employee's mandates or functions;
- b. It is required to meet the needs of the Department, agency, bureau or office, or there is a substantial benefit to be derived by the State;
- c. The presence of the official or employee is critical to the outcome of the meeting, conference, seminar consultation or any activity to be attended; and,
- d. The projected expenses are not excessive or involve minimum expenditure.³¹

Moreover, all officials authorized to approve local or overseas travels are required, as far as practicable, to minimize travel cost.³²

8.3.5. As provided in E.O. No. 77, the following individuals shall not be issued foreign travel authorities and shall not be entitled to government funding for such trips:

- a. Private individuals;
- b. Consultants and/or those engaged by way of contract of service by government agencies, except in highly meritorious circumstances (e.g., unavailability of qualified employees in highly technical or specialized fields), and upon written justification submitted to the authorized approving officials; and,

²⁹ See **Annex G** for the standard template of the Affidavit of Undertaking

³⁰ Department Order No. 2019-009 dated 29 May 2019.

³¹ Section 3(a), Executive Order No. 77 dated 15 March 2019 with the subject, "Prescribing Rules and Regulations and Rates of Expenses and Allowances for Official Local and Foreign Travels of Government Personnel."

³² Section 3(b), E.O. 77

- c. Spouses or children of government officials, except when diplomatic protocol or international practices provide otherwise.³³

8.4. STUDY PROPER

- 8.4.1. During the study proper of the program, the PDC Secretariat shall establish an active communication line for the grantee through the assignment of an HR coordinator to ensure regular monitoring and coordination of activities among the grantee, mentor, Development Partner and the host organization (if applicable).
- 8.4.2. Throughout the duration of the program, the grantee must provide updates on:
 - a. Performance Rating at the end of each term (if applicable),
 - b. Highlights through the program,
 - c. Feedback on ongoing mentorship/coaching (if applicable),
 - d. Proposed revisions to the REAP (if needed).
- 8.4.3. For study programs (local or foreign), the grantee must provide updates including:
 - a. Academic performance at the end of each term;
 - b. Highlights of the term completed, including documentation of modules taken, key learning, and challenges faced;
 - c. Mentoring and Coaching activities, including dates of sessions, and any revisions to the REAP; and,
 - d. Critical incidents that could affect the scholar's study, such as illness or accident of themselves or family members, loss of equipment critical for study or other serious incident.
- 8.4.4. The PDC Secretariat and L&D unit of the agency concerned shall serve as the support system for the scholar(s) to ensure their well-being during their stay away from home (for foreign-hosted programs) by establishing a regular session with the scholar for guidance, counseling or for any other matters.

8.5. POST-STUDY

- 8.5.1. After completion of the program and returning to work, the scholar should deliver on the following:

³³ Section 3(b), E.O. 77

- i. Turnover of transcript of records, certificate of completion or similar document as proof of successful completion of the scholarship program and other requirements set by the Development Partner;
- ii. Submission of written report (for short-term training or study) or post-training report (for long-term training or study) within seven (7) days or thirty (30) days respectively, upon return to duty;
- iii. Application, sharing or delivery of skills learned from the study or training (including the conduct of echo session/s for the transfer of knowledge) within third (30) days upon return to duty; and,
- iv. Submission of the Re-Entry Action Plan (REAP) prior to the start of the program and its finalization and implementation upon return of the grantee (when applicable);

A. REAP IMPLEMENTATION

- 8.5.2 Within thirty (30) calendar days upon return, the grantee must present the REAP implementation plan to the PDC for final assessment and approval;
- 8.5.3 The grantee must start implementing the approved REAP within the timeline as specified. Should the REAP require further enhancement or revision, the grantee with the assistance of the mentor shall amend within fifteen (15) calendar days. Thereafter, the revised REAP shall be presented to the PDC for approval.
- 8.5.4 A monthly progress consultation shall be made between the PDC Secretariat and the grantee.
- 8.5.5 Upon completion of the REAP implementation, a post-evaluation will be conducted by the PDC to determine its success in relation to addressing the needs of the agency.
- 8.5.6 The PDC Secretariat shall provide updates on the status of all REAPs on a regular periodic basis as determined by the PDC.

8.6. IMPACT EVALUATION

- 8.6.1. During the conduct of the annual OTNA, the PDC shall also include its assessment on the contributive value of all the scholarship and training programs availed and completed for a given year, taking in consideration the following factors:

- a. Cost of the program and all incidental expenses incurred by the government;
- b. Time spent by the grantee away from the agency;
- c. Extent or degree of progress gained by the organization from the REAP implemented (if applicable);
- d. Acquisition of a new competency or advancing to a higher level of an existing competency by the employee and the office;
- e. Significant improvement in the performance of the employee and the office/agency as a direct or contributory result of completing the program; and,
- f. Other relevant factors as may be determined by the PDC.

9. RULES ON STRAY SCHOLARSHIPS

- 9.1. Availment of stray scholarships by DOTr personnel's own initiative are encouraged, provided that:
 - a. The personnel formally sought clearance from the head of the office prior to application;
 - b. The training or scholarship program is fully funded by the Development Partner, or from other sources and is availed through the personnel's initiative; and,
 - c. The training or scholarship program addresses an identified competency gap of the employee and the office or agency concerned per the IDP of the personnel and the HR L&D Plan of the agency; and,
 - d. A REAP shall be proposed and implemented, which must be necessary or have a valuable contribution to the strategic objectives of the Department.
- 9.2. An employee who pursues a stray scholarship may apply for an SSC to the PDC which must be supported with an endorsement from the head of the office concerned.
- 9.3. To apply for a Scholarship Service Contract (SSC), the employee concerned shall submit a request to the PDC Secretariat upon confirmed acceptance to the training or scholarship program availed at the personnel's own initiative, which must be supported by the following documentary requirements:
 - a. Accomplished Nomination Form signed by the head of office concerned,
 - b. Updated Personal Data Sheet (PDS),
 - c. Updated Service Record,

- d. Statement of actual duties and responsibilities,
 - e. Individual Performance Commitment Review (IPCR) ratings for the last two (2) rating periods,
 - f. Accomplished Potential Assessment Form;
 - g. Certification of No Pending Administrative Case,
 - h. Proof of Acceptance from the Development Partner or Host Organization,
 - i. REAP Proposal³⁴
- 9.4. All applications relating to stray scholarships shall be evaluated by the PDC Secretariat. Only those who have met the minimum eligibility requirements set by the Department as stipulated in Section 8.2(B) of this Order shall be subject to deliberation before the PDC.
- 9.5. The PDC shall assess and deliberate on the application of the employee to be awarded the SSC for a stray scholarship in accordance with the selection criteria and additional guidelines as stipulated in Section 8.2(D) and (E) of this Order.
- 9.6. In case an SSC is granted in favor of the employee, the PDC resolution or referendum shall state the identified mentor of the grantee who shall guide the employee in the further development and implementation of the REAP for the duration and upon completion of the program.
- 9.7. Upon the execution of the SSC, the grantee shall continue to regularly receive salaries from the government for the duration of the study/training, and shall also receive all entitlements (e.g., pre-travel allowance and issuance of an official passport, if necessary.) due as a government fellow on study/training in accordance with Civil Service rules and regulations another relevant issuances.³⁵
- 9.8. Under the SSC, the grantee of a stray scholarship shall be bound by the same rules and requirements for regular grantees for the duration and upon completion of the training or scholarship program as stipulated in Section 11 of this Order.
- 9.9. As an alternative to Section 9.2, the employee may apply for a Study Leave to the appropriate office pursuant to CSC MC No. 21 s. 2004, or file for a leave of absence chargeable against their vacation leave credits as may be applicable.
- 9.10. In case the grantee opts to pursue the study on vacation leave, no service obligation contract shall be required. The employee shall continue to receive one's salary only for the duration of accumulated vacation leave credits. Once

³⁴ In case a REAP is not required by the Development Partner or host organization, the employee shall still submit a REAP proposal subject to the approval of the PDC.

³⁵ See Section 11.2 of this Order.

fully exhausted, the employee shall remain on the rolls on vacation leave without pay provided that it does not exceed one calendar year.³⁶

- 9.11. If the duration of the grant is thirty (30) days or more, the employee shall be required to file an office clearance from property and money accountabilities for the duration of the program.³⁷
- 9.12. The grantee shall have the option to report for work or not when one's services are required by the office during the duration of the grant. If the grantee opts to report for work, the period covered will be correspondingly deducted from the required service obligation.

10. RULES ON WITHDRAWALS AND DEFERMENT

- 10.1. In case a DOTr nominee who has been awarded a training or scholarship voluntarily withdraws from the program with or without a valid reason, the PDC shall award the same to the alternate if substitution is still possible.
- 10.2. In such case, the PDC Secretariat shall assist the substitute nominee in going through the selection process of the Development Partner.
- 10.3. A nominee, who withdraws without valid reason from the program after an award is made, shall be disqualified to reapply by the PDC over a period equivalent to the duration of the program plus the corresponding service obligation or two years, whichever is longer. Further, the nominee shall reimburse the Department and the Development Partner on actual expenses which may have been incurred in connection with their nomination.
- 10.4. The same sanctions as provided in the preceding paragraph shall also apply to any nominee who withdraws from the training or scholarship program due to the individual's failure to comply with any of the requirements of the Development Partner, which may result to the Department's forfeiture from the program due to the lack of sufficient time for the PDC to mobilize a substitute.
- 10.5. No deferment of a training or scholarship grant³⁸ shall be granted by the PDC except when the processing application or delay was due to causes from the side of the Development Partner. In such cases, the PDC shall determine the merits of the request on a case-to-case basis.

³⁶ Based on Section 57 of the Omnibus Rules on Leave, "Leave without pay not exceeding one year may be granted, in addition to the vacation and/or sick leave earned.

³⁷ CSC Resolution No. 84-034

³⁸ E.g., the nominee opts to not undertake the training for the specific period and requests the award be availed in the subsequent cycle or sometime in the future.

11. RULES ON SERVICE OBLIGATION

11.1. Each Scholarship Service Contract shall contain at least the following obligations of the grantee:

- a. The grantee shall keep up with the necessary standards of scholarship or accomplishment;
- b. The grantee shall live up to the terms and conditions of the grant;
- c. The grantee shall conduct oneself in such a manner as not to bring disgrace or dishonor to oneself or to the country;
- d. The grantee shall return to work immediately upon the termination of scholarship or training program;
- e. After completion of the scholarship or training grant, to render the compulsory service obligation equivalent to the period of scholarship/training as indicated in the SSC and in line with Annex A of this Order;
- f. After completion of the program and returning to work, the grantee shall deliver on the post-study requirements as stipulated in Section 8.5 of this Guidelines;
- g. Refund in full the Philippine Government and the Development Partner such amount or amounts as may have been defrayed for the grantee's transportation, salary, allowances and other expenses incidental to the grant of the scholarship or training program under the following instances:
 - i. Failure to render, in full or in part, the required length of service on account of voluntary resignation, retirement, separation from the service through the grantee's own fault, or other causes within the employee's control;
 - ii. Cancellation of the grant or removal of the grantee from the scholarship or study grant due to the employee's own fault or willful neglect;
 - iii. Other violations to the terms and conditions of the SSC as may be determined by the PDC.

11.2. Each SSC shall likewise contain the following obligations of the agency³⁹:

- a. The agency shall grant temporary release to the grantee from all official duties and responsibilities for the duration of the program;

³⁹ Executive Order No. 129, s. 1968

- b. The agency shall shoulder the necessary expenses required by the grantee and pay all the benefits/remuneration due to the employee for the duration of the program;
 - c. The agency shall provide the necessary assistance and support to the grantee in completing the post-study requirements of the program, especially in the implementation of the REAP (when applicable).
- 11.3. In the event that a grantee is transferred or reassigned to another agency for causes beyond the employee's control, the remaining service obligation as stipulated in the SSC shall be rendered in the receiving agency. Any pending REAP implementation shall be turned over to the head of the office concerned and the PDC Secretariat.
- 11.4. In such case that the grantee decided to resign or file an early retirement with an ongoing service obligation or has not completed the implementation of REAP, such grantee may be allowed to resign or retire but shall reimburse the Department and the Development Partner on actual expenses which may have been incurred in connection with the scholarship grant.
- 11.5. An employee who has yet to fully render the required service obligation to the Department and to comply with the post-study requirements for a previous L&D program availment shall not be granted a scholarship service contract for another training or scholarship program unless the same have been fully served and delivered.
- 11.6. Provided that the post-study requirements for the previous scholarship or training program have been completed, an employee with a pending service obligation may be granted an SSC for another program under the following circumstances:
- a. The current program applied for is in the same field as the previously-availed program and is designed as an advancement⁴⁰ to the career path or specialization of the candidate, provided that two (2) years of continuous government service has been rendered in the same field. In such cases, the prescribed period has only been substantially served, the PDC may opt to disqualify the candidate or add the deficiency in the service obligation for the program applied for; and,
 - b. In case the previous program availed is different from the field of the current program applied for, there must be at least a three (3) year interval between the date of return of the nominee and the start of the new program.

⁴⁰ This shall refer to the professional development (degree) programs as provided in Item 8.1(C) of this Order. To illustrate, for a master's degree previously earned, advancement shall refer to a subsequent doctorate degree. In no case shall "enrichment program" be construed as advancement or specialization of a prior enrichment program, regardless of the course content of both programs.

11.7. The grantee may request the PDC concerned for an extension to the participation to the study or non-study L&D program, provided that:

- a. The request is made by the grantee upon the recommendation of the program advisor and/or the Development Partner, and concurred by the head of the office/project unit concerned;
- b. Said request is submitted to the PDC concerned at least one (1) month (for non-study programs) or six (6) months (for study programs) prior to the expiration of the travel authority issued; and,
- c. In the case of foreign scholarship or training programs conducted in the host country, said request shall be made at least six (6) months before the expiration of the grantee's passport, which must still be valid by the end of the requested extension and the adjusted date of departure from the host country;⁴¹

12. DISSEMINATION/COMMUNICATION PLAN

12.1. These Guidelines shall be furnished to the officials, service directors, division chiefs, employees association concerned of the DOfTr-Central Office, DOfTr-MRT3 PMO, regional offices (CAR and CARAGA), sectoral offices (LTO and LTFRB), and other attached agencies of the Department.

12.2. Further, the Human Resource Development Division of the DOfTr-Central Office shall conduct an orientation within six (6) months from its approval to the following offices:

12.2.1. DOfTr-Central Office – Officials, Service Directors and Division Chiefs

12.2.2. DOfTr-MRT3 PMO, Regional and Sectoral Offices and Attached Agencies – Human Resource Management Officers and Personnel Development Committee Members

12.3. It shall be the responsibility of the HR unit and/or PDC Secretariat of the respective agencies to orient the affected personnel upon receipt of this Guidelines and after attending the orientation. For the Central Office, the Division Chiefs shall orient their respective staff upon receipt of the policy and upon undergoing the same orientation.

13. IMPLEMENTATION CLAUSE

The regional and sectoral offices and attached agencies shall issue the appropriate internal guidelines of procedure in implementing the provisions of this Order within their respective jurisdictions.

⁴¹ This requirement shall not apply to study programs which are conducted through online or distance learning platforms/facilities.

14. SEPARABILITY CLAUSE

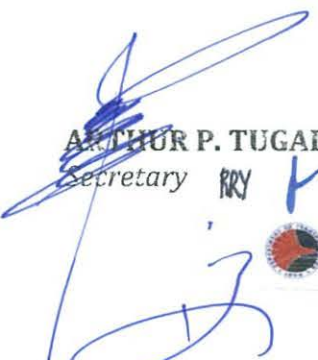
In the event that any provision or part of this policy is declared illegal or rendered invalid by competent authority, those provisions not affected by such declaration shall remain valid and effective.

15. REPEALING CLAUSE

All issuances inconsistent with these Guidelines shall be deemed superseded, amended or repealed accordingly.

16. EFFECTIVITY

This Department Order shall take effect immediately and shall remain in force unless superseded by an appropriate issuance.


ARTHUR P. TUGADE
Secretary RRY


DOT-OSDC OUTGOING 21-000587

REFERENCES

- CSC Memorandum Circular No. 21, s. 2004 dated 14 September 2004 – "Amendment to Section 68 of CSC MC No. 14, s. 1999 relative to the Guidelines on Study Leave."
- Magna Carta of Women (RA 9710)
- Magna Carta for Disabled Persons (RA 7277)
- CSC Resolution No. 180069 dated 03 July 2018 re. the 2017 Omnibus Rules on Appointments and Other Human Resource Actions (ORA-OHRA), Revised in 2018.
- Executive Order No. 367 s. 1989, "Further Amending Executive Order No. 367, s. 1989."
- CSC Memorandum Circular No. 44, s. 1992 with the subject, "Guidelines and Operating Procedures in the Administration of the Scholarship Program for Government"
- Implementing Rules and Regulations of Republic Act No. 9710
- CSC Memorandum Circular No. 02, s. 2001 with the subject, "Revised Policies on the Settlement of Grievances in the Public Sector."
- Omnibus Rules on Leave (Amended by CSC MC No. 41, s. 1998)
- CSC Resolution No. 84-034
- Executive Order No. 129, s. 1968 with the subject, "Providing Rules and Regulations Governing Official Travel Abroad of Officials and Employees of the Government, Both National and Local, Including Government-Owned or Controlled Corporations, and Prescribing Rates of Allowances and Other Expenses Therefore."
- Executive Order No. 161, s. 1994 with the subject, "Prescribing the Adoption of New Standard Forms to Be Accomplished by Officials and Employees for Overseas Training."
- Executive Order No. 77, s. 2019 with the subject, "Prescribing Rules and Regulations and Rates of Expenses and Allowances for Official Local and Foreign Travels of Government Personnel"
- General Provisions of the General Appropriations Act, FY 2021
- DBM National Budget Circular No. 563, s. 2016 with the subject, "Guidelines on Participation of Government Officials and Employees in Conventions, Seminars, Conferences, Symposia and Similar Non-Training Gatherings Sponsored by Non-Government Organizations or Private Institutions"
- DBM Budget Circular No. 2007-1 with the subject, "Guidelines on the Grant of Honoraria to Lecturers, Resource Persons, Coordinators and Facilitators"
- DOTr Department Order No. 91-537 with the subject, "Revised Guidelines on Trainings, Seminars, Scholarships, International Meetings, Conferences, Workshops, Special Missions and Other Study Trips"
- DOTr Department Order No. 91-537 with the subject, "Addendum to Department Order No. 91-537"
- DOTr Department Order No. 2019-009 with the subject, "Rules, Regulations and Rates of Expenses and Allowances for Official and Foreign Travels of Government Personnel"

SERVICE OBLIGATION MATRIX

DURATION OF LEARNING PROGRAM	DURATION OF SERVICE OBLIGATION	MONETARY VALUE
Less than two (2) months	Six (6) months	Monthly Salary, Personnel Economic Relief Allowance (PERA)
Two (2) months to less than six (6) months	One (1) year	Monthly Salary, Personnel Economic Relief Allowance (PERA), and either 13 th or 14 th Month Pay and other incentives given by the Department/ Agency
One (1) year	Two (2) years	Monthly Salary, Personnel Economic Relief Allowance (PERA), and 13 th Month Pay Monthly Salary, Personnel Economic Relief Allowance (PERA), 13 th & 14 th Month Pay and other incentives given by the Department/ Agency
One and a half years (1 ½)	Three (3) years	Monthly Salary, Personnel Economic Relief Allowance (PERA), and 13 th Month Pay Monthly Salary, Personnel Economic Relief Allowance (PERA), (2) 13 th & 14 th Month Pay and other incentives given by the Department/ Agency
Two (2) Years	Four (4) Years	Monthly Salary, Personnel Economic Relief Allowance (PERA), and 13 th Month Pay Monthly Salary, Personnel Economic Relief Allowance (PERA) with two (2) 13 th & 14 th Month Pays and other incentives given by the Department/ Agency

* Additional funding requested for local scholarships shall require an additional one (1) month service obligation for every ₱ 10,000.00 grant or a fraction thereof.

RATING GUIDE FOR QUANTITATIVE CRITERIA

I. POSITION (10% for Non-Study Programs)

If the candidate is an incumbent of the position expressly prescribed by the program, the full 10% shall be awarded, otherwise 5% shall be given to the employee.

II. LENGTH OF SERVICE (20% for Study Programs; 10% for Non-Study Programs)

Study	Each year shall be equivalent to 2% up to a maximum of 20%
Non-Study	Each year shall be equivalent to 1% up to a maximum of 10%

III. NECESSITY (50% for Non-Study Programs without REAP requirement; 30% for Study Programs and Non-Study Programs with REAP requirement)

Necessity shall refer to the relevance of the course to the official functions of the nominee.

1. For Study Programs: Those already with master's degrees shall be given least priority for study programs leading to master's degrees. Likewise, those already with a PhD degree or a professional doctoral degree shall be given least priority for doctoral scholarship programs.

Without Master's/Doctoral Degree		Master's/Doctoral Degree	
SG 22-24	50%	Any position, provided that it was acquired through government assistance (official time, study leave, financial assistance, other government related assistance)	20%
SG 18-21	40%		
SG 15-17	30%		
SG 11-14	20%	Obtained on personal capacity	10%
SG 10 below	10%		

2. For Non-Study Programs

Without any training on present functions in the last two (2) years	50%
With less than two (2) short term trainings on present functions in the last two (2) years	40%
With more than two (2) short term trainings on present functions in the last two (2) years)	30%
With at least one (1) long term training program on present functions in the last two (2) years)	20%

IV. EQUITY (30%)

Twenty (20%) percent of the total score shall be for rating the nominee, while ten (10%) percent shall be for rating the office/unit where the nominee is from.

Office Rating (10%)	The nominees will be ranked on the basis of scholarship availments of their respective offices for the last two (2) years. The nominee whose office had the least availment shall automatically gain 10%; the remaining nominees shall be scored correspondingly using a difference of $10/n$, where n is the number of nominees.		
Individual Rating (20%)	Criteria	YES	NO
	Has availed previous scholarship		20%
	Has availed scholarship and completed service obligation plus four (4) years		
	Non-Degree	16%	
	Master's Degree	14%	
	Doctorate Degree	12%	
	Has completed service obligation	10%	
	Not yet completed service obligation but the program is an advancement from previous program	5%	0%

V. POTENTIAL IMPACT OF REAP PROPOSAL (20% for Study Programs and Non-Study Programs with REAP requirement)

For study programs and non-study programs with REAP requirement, 20% of the total score shall be allotted for the rating of the potential impact of the proposed **Re-Entry Action Plan (REAP)** submitted by the scholar/grantee. The assessment shall be based on the organization's area of priority to make sure that the availed learning & development intervention has a positive impact and guaranteed return on investment (ROI) to the organization, leading to significant improvements or innovations in the agency's delivery of services to the public.

Most Necessary	20%
Necessary	12%
Least Necessary	5%



Republic of the Philippines

Department of Transportation

ANNEX C

Document No: DOTr-HRDD-Forms-001

Rev. No.: 001

Effective Date: 14 April 2021

LEARNING AND DEVELOPMENT NOMINATION FORM

INSTRUCTIONS: This form is used in nominating an employee to undergo in a Learning & Development Training. Fill-out this form and attach the signed and scanned copy in the Online Nomination Form.

Title of Training/Course: _____

I. Participants Information	
Name of Personnel:	ID Number:
Position Title:	Office/Unit Head:
Gender (Optional):	Immediate Supervisor:
II. Reason/Justification of Nominee's Attendance: (Relevance of the course to the participant's functions)	
III. Duties and Responsibilities of Nominee: (To be filled out by the Supervisor)	
IV. Gender Equality, Disability and Social Inclusion (GEDSI)	
1. Do you have mobility problems? Like difficulty in walking and/or climbing stairs?	☐ Yes ☐ No
2. Are you having an emotional/behavioral problem?	☐ Yes ☐ No
3. Do you have difficulty in reading and identifying speech sounds?	☐ Yes ☐ No
4. Do you have difficulty communicating?	☐ Yes ☐ No
5. Do you have difficulty remembering or concentrating?	☐ Yes ☐ No
6. Do you have difficulty in doing simple arithmetic calculations?	☐ Yes ☐ No
7. Do you have difficulty in reading even with corrective lenses?	☐ Yes ☐ No
8. Do you have any difficulty in hearing?	☐ Yes ☐ No
V. Social Inclusion	
1. Are you a solo parent?	☐ Yes ☐ No
2. Are you part of the Indigenous People group? (Please specify.)	☐ Yes ☐ No
<i>This is to certify that I have briefed the nominee of the expected output and we have agreed on how and when he/she will apply the new learning in the workplace.</i>	
Signature of Immediate Supervisor	Signature of Participant

POTENTIAL ASSESSMENT FORM

Name: _____ Age: _____
 Present Position: _____
 Division/Service: _____
 Nominated for: _____
 (Course Title)

Instruction: Rate the potential of the candidate using the equivalent Point Scores.

Excellent	=	5
Very Good	=	4
Good	=	3
Fair	=	2
Poor	=	1

After which, add all the scores and divide the sum by the total number of items scored. Multiply the quotient by 5% (weight for Superior Potential Assessment) to get the point score for potential.

I. HUMAN RELATIONS**POINT SCORE****A. Ability to adapt/adjust to the organization**

1. Is he/she able to adjust to the working environment of the organization?

B. Ability to relate with superiors

1. How well does he/she respond to your request, work demands and expectations?

C. Ability to relate with peers in his/her Unit

1. Is he/she accepted and respected by his peers?

2. Does he/she help his/her peer resolving problems?

D. Ability to deal with the clientele or personnel outside of his/her Unit

1. Does he/she show enthusiasm in providing assistance to other personnel?

II. LEADERSHIP

1. Is he/she able to encourage his/her peers and/or subordinates to participate in problem solving and decision making?

III. WORK ORGANIZATION

1. Is he/she well-organized or systematic in his/her work?

IV. REACTION TO PRESSURE

1. Can he/she work effectively even under pressure, conflict of priorities and with existing work environment?

2. Is he/she able to control negative emotions?

3. Does he/she accept criticisms objectively?

V. DEDICATION TO WORK

1. Does he/she cooperate for rush projects or special assignments?

VI. RESOURCEFULNESS AND INITIATIVE

1. Can he/she accomplish assignments without close supervision?
2. Does he/she seek for additional assignments or offer his/her help to others after completing his/her work?

VII. INTEREST IN THE ORGANIZATION

1. Does he/she support new systems or procedures that promote work efficiency?

TOTAL

Equivalent Point $[(\text{total}/\text{items}) \times .05]$

Rated by:

Concurred by:

Immediate Supervisor

Next Higher Supervisor

Date: _____

<AGENCY NAME>
<NAME OF HR/ADMIN DIVISION CONCERNED>

RE-ENTRY ACTION PLAN (REAP) FORM

Scholarship Program: _____

Development Partner: _____

I. REAP BACKGROUND AND INFORMATION	
a. REAP Title	
b. REAP Objective	
c. Problem/Opportunity	
d. Description in relation to the Department i. Organization Outcome ii. Target Competency Improvement	
e. Direct Beneficiary	
f. Women and disadvantaged groups	
g. Relation to the Government's Development Plan	
h. Output	

II. REAP TIMELINE AND IMPLEMENTATION		
a. Measurability		
b. Sustainability		
c. Predictive Action Steps with Identified Success Indicators		
i. Phase/Stage	ii. Expected Output	iii. Timeline

d. <i>Target Date to Start</i>	
e. <i>Target Date to End</i>	

III. RESOURCES

IV. COMMENTS AND RECOMMENDATION	
a. <i>Immediate Superior (Mentor)</i>	
b. <i>Head of the Office/Division/Service</i>	
c. <i>Human Resource Development Division</i>	

Prepared by:

Applicant

Recommended by:

Immediate Superior (Mentor)

Approved and noted by:

Head of the Office/Division/Service

SCHOLARSHIP SERVICE CONTRACT

The Government of the Philippines through the

(Agency/Office)

represented by _____

(Head of Agency/Office)

hereinafter called the GRANTOR; and,

(Name of Grantee)

of legal age, Filipino, Single/Married, presently residing at

herein after called the GRANTEE; and,

(Name of Guarantor)

of legal age, Filipino, Single/Married, presently residing at

herein after called the GUARANTOR;

hereby agree to be bound by this scholarship service contract.

WITNESSETH:

That pursuant to the provisions of Executive Order No. 129, s. 1968, as amended, and in consideration of the grant and acceptance by the GRANTEE of a scholarship/training award to undergo on official time a program entitled _____ from _____ to _____, 20 _____, the GRANTEE hereby agrees to fulfill the following terms and conditions:

1. That the Grantee shall keep up with the standards of scholarship or award;
2. That the Grantee shall conduct him/herself in a manner as not to bring disgrace or dishonor to him/herself and/or his/her country;
3. That the Grantee shall submit to the head of his/her Office and to the Scholarship Committee on Scholarships (SCS) at the end of each term, his/her official transcript of grades, certificate of performance or its equivalent;
4. That, if there is sufficient reason for the extension of the Grantee's original scholarship/training/award, he/she shall submit a formal request to his/her agency, with justification and recommendation from his/her Program Adviser, six (6) months prior to the expiration of his/her travel authority/validity of the passport. It is understood that approval of the extension shall be made only upon the recommendation of the Grantee's agency to the SCS and upon the grantee's execution of a supplementary training scholarship contract covering the extension period;
5. That the Grantee shall return immediately to the Philippines and report to his/her office upon the completion or termination of his/her scholarship, fellowship or training grant;
6. That the Grantee shall submit to his/her Office, to the SCS and to other concerned offices, a completion report on his/her training/scholarship within sixty (60) days after his/her return to duty, as per attached outline, and conduct echo-seminar within fifteen (15) days upon return to work;

7. That the Grantee shall serve his/her office or any other government office or instrumentally for the period of _____ years (s) as exigencies of the service require per Section 2 of EO 367.

8. That the Grantee accepts the value of the fellowship as follows:

a. Transportation (GOP; Local & International)	-	P_____	\$_____
b. Tuition other fees	-	P_____	\$_____
c. Allowances (GOP & Sponsor)	-	P_____	\$_____
Clothing	-	P_____	\$_____
Living/Stipends			_____
Establishments			_____
Books			_____
d. Salaries, other emoluments and adjustments	-	P_____	\$_____
TOTAL	-	P_____	\$_____

9. That should the Grantee fail to comply with the foregoing conditions through his/her fault or willful neglect, resignation, voluntary retirement or other causes within his/her control, he/she shall refund to his/her Office the amount defrayed by the Philippine Government and the sponsor as enumerated in Section 8.

Proportionate refund shall be allowed, provided that the Grantee has served his or her Office or agency at least 75% of his/her total service obligation.

10. That the Grantee shall have a Guarantor as his/her co-maker or co-signor in this contract who shall assume full responsibility jointly and severally should he/she fail to comply with the conditions set forth.

In WITNEESS WHEREOF, we have hereunder set our hands this _____ day of _____, 20_____, at _____.

Head of Agency
(GOP Representative)

Grantee

Guarantor/Address
(Relative of the Grantee)

ACKNOWLEDGMENT

REPUBLIC OF THE PHILIPPINES)
_____) S.S.

BEFORE ME, this _____ day of _____, 20____ in the Municipality
of _____, Philippines, personally appeared _____,
(Name of Grantee)
with Residence Certificate No. _____ issued at _____ on
_____; _____, with Residence Certificate No.
(Name of Guarantor)
_____ issued at _____ on _____,
respectively, known to me to be the same persons who executed the foregoing instrument
and they acknowledged to me that the same is their free act and deed.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, I have hereunto set my hand this _____ day of _____, 20_____.

Doc. No. _____
Page No. _____
Book No. _____
Series of 20 _____



Agency Letterhead

CERTIFICATE OF UNDERTAKING

The undersigned hereby undertakes to complete the official business to
_____ on _____ for the
_____.

The undersigned further undertakes not to accept any monetary consideration and/or other related assistance outside of what is being provided by the Philippine Government/inviting organization.

Name

Position

Office/Agency



(Always Attached this Form to
All Communications)

Reference No. OSEC 21-002045

RECEIVED BY: MICH C/O RONA

POTROAUT 21-2012

○ Aug 21-1916

ORIGINATING OFFICE:

USEC. AUT

SUBJECT:

Date of Document

26 APRIL 2021

PROPOSED DEPT. ORDER RE: RULES AND REGULATIONS GOVERNING TRAINING AND SCHOLARSHIP PROGRAMS IN THE DEPARTMENT. /

Date/Time Received

05 MAY 2021 1146H

ACTIONS UNDERTAKE

DOTC
OFFICE OF THE DIRECTOR, ADMINISTRATIVE SERVICE
MAY 11 2021
BY: [Signature] J. B.